

A

Collocations with *cause* and *effect*

We have yet to **establish the cause** of this latest outbreak of foot-and-mouth disease.
 Mass unemployment is believed to be the **root cause**¹ of the riots.
 The research team thinks that a virus is the **primary cause**² of this type of cancer.
 The President said it would take time for the reforms to produce the **desired effect**.
 It is likely to be some weeks before we **feel the full effect** of the rise in interest rates.
 This morning's delays to flights have **had a knock-on effect**³ on departures all day.
 The children involved in the hijack are not expected to suffer any long-term **ill effects**⁴.

¹ origin³ indirect result (NOT ~~make~~ an effect)² main cause⁴ negative results (Note that *ill* here means *bad* rather than *sick*)

B

Other words meaning *cause*

example	meaning
The advertising campaign didn't produce the results we hoped for.	lead to the results
The Finance Minister's decision to raise income tax provoked an outcry .	caused a lot of public anger
If teachers show favouritism, it breeds resentment .	makes others feel angry and unhappy
Mary didn't believe the rumours about her boss but they planted doubts in her mind.	made her feel uncertain
The film star's photo prompted speculation that she may be pregnant.	caused people to suspect
Email rendered the fax machine obsolete .	caused to be no longer used
If you want to make an insurance claim, you can set the wheels in motion by filling in this form.	make something start to happen
This wind will wreak havoc with my flowers!	cause a lot of damage to
Our new neighbours are so noisy, it's enough to drive anyone crazy !	informal, make angry and upset
The strike could spell disaster for the country.	cause serious problems

C

Talking about reasons and consequences

- Mr Ball: Why did Jack behave so badly in class? There must have been some **compelling reason**¹ surely. He must have known there'd be **dire consequences**².
- Miss Cane: I don't know. I think his parents' financial problems might be a **contributing factor** but he refused to **give me a reason**. Anyway, I sent him to the headteacher and I'm sure she'll **demand an explanation**.
- Mr Ball: Yes, she'll certainly make him **face the consequences** of his actions!

¹ very powerful reason² very serious consequences

Exercises

53.1 Match the beginning of each sentence with its ending.

- | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|
| 1 I think that computers will eventually render | havoc in low-lying areas. |
| 2 The preliminary meeting set the wheels | an outcry from the staff. |
| 3 Her mother calling her sister 'the pretty one' bred | speculation that he is unwell. |
| 4 I always suspected the new tax law would spell | a positive result. |
| 5 I'm sure that your hard work will produce | us crazy. |
| 6 The boss's decision to cut wages provoked | disaster for the economy. |
| 7 The way he behaved last night planted | a lot of resentment in her. |
| 8 The minister's absence has prompted | of the new project in motion. |
| 9 The uncertainty of the situation is driving | books obsolete. |
| 10 The floods last week wrought | doubts in my mind about his honesty. |

53.2 Complete each sentence using a word from the opposite page. The first letters are given for you.

- Henry's mother d..... an explanation for his extraordinary behaviour.
- Fortunately the consequences were not as d..... as we had anticipated.
- Now I dread having to f..... the consequences of my over-hasty decision to hand in my notice.
- Do you have any c..... reason for wanting to invite Zoë to come too?
- When I asked the doctor why I felt so exhausted, he said that stress might be a c..... factor.
- Can you give me any sensible r..... why we should do something so risky?
- Unfortunately, the sleeping pills she's taking are not having the d..... effect.
- The hurricane has w..... havoc along the Florida coast.
- I suspect that the journalist deliberately wanted to p..... doubts in his readers' minds about the effectiveness of the recent security measures.

53.3 Order the words to form sentences.

- the / next / nearly / crazy. / dust / site / building / The / me / is / from / driving / door
- them / will / time / establish / of / It / a / the / the / take / cause / long / accident. / to
- motion / If / now, / your / week. / things / we / next / visa / ready / should / set / in / be
- out / customer / produced / results. / The / survey / company / surprising / carried / which / the / some

53.4 Answer these questions.

- What is the desired effect of any medication?
- Is a knock-on effect usually welcomed or not?
- Which other collocation in A has a similar meaning to *primary cause*?
- If a dentist gives you a local anaesthetic injection, how long does it usually take before you feel the full effect of the injection?
- Do you think society has suffered any ill effects as the result of the invention of television?
- Can you name an invention that has been rendered obsolete by new technology?

53.5 Use a dictionary such as the Cambridge Online Dictionary to find collocations with (a) *cause* and (b) *effect*. Write four sentences for each word.